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Democracy Dies in Darkness

TUESDAY, NOVEMBER 10, 2026 · **$4**

Trump defends embattled Nvidia CEO

President says Huang denied knowing affair partner was Chinese spy

BY CAT ZAKRZEWSKI, IAN DUNCAN AND JOSHUA YANG

President Donald Trump said Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang denied knowing a woman he admitted an affair with was an alleged Chinese spy, offering his personal support for his embattled tech ally.

"I did speak to him today," Trump told reporters at a news conference on Monday. "And he he said he had absolutely no idea that the person in question was a spy. ... I really believe him."

Trump said he did not know about the allegations of spying when he invited Huang to accompany him on a trip to China earlier this year. But he declined to say when he first was informed about the intelligence community's concerns that the woman, Alice Huang, an executive at Singapore-based tech company and Nvidia customer Megaspeed, worked with one of Beijing's intelligence agencies.

SEE **NVIDIA** ON **A18**

Learning the ropes



J. SCOTT APPLEWHITE/AP

From left, Sen.-elect Annie Andrews (D-South Carolina), Sen.-elect James Talarico (D-Texas) and Sen.-elect Troy Jackson (D-Maine) walk together as the newly elected senators arrive for orientation Monday.

GOP's sprint to the finish

REPUBLICANS' LAST SHOT TO PASS AGENDA

Only weeks remain before Democrats take control

BY THEODORIC MEYER AND JARRELL DILLARD

Lawmakers returned to Washington on Monday for the first time since Democrats reclaimed the House and the Senate in the midterm elections, kicking off a legislative sprint before the transfer of power on Jan. 3.

Some Republicans are pushing to do as much as they can before they lose control.

Congress is scheduled to be in session for five more weeks before the end of the year — but some Republicans in both chambers are urging their colleagues to work weekends and holidays to confirm as many of President Donald Trump's nominees and pass as much legislation as they can in the lame-duck session.

Those priorities could include sending more money to the Pentagon to replenish munitions used in the Iran war and passing a bipartisan bill to overhaul the

SEE **LAME DUCK** ON **A9**

2028: Democrats are eyeing the possibility of a supermajority. **A5**

Hegseth impeachment effort begins

Focus is on the defense secretary's role in overseeing the Iran war

BY NOAH ROBERTSON, NATALIE ALLISON AND TARA COPP

A Republican lawmaker introduced articles of impeachment against Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth on Monday, in a bid to force House members to vote on whether they support the polarizing Cabinet official.

The effort, led by Rep. Thomas Massie (Kentucky), centers on Hegseth's role overseeing the unpopular Iran war, which top GOP officials have blamed for their crushing losses in last week's midterm elections.

Massie has alleged that the war is unconstitutional because the Trump administration initiated the conflict without the approval of lawmakers and has since continued military action despite Congress demanding that the Pentagon cease hostilities.

Reading the impeachment articles on the House floor, Massie said that Hegseth had "abused" his powers as defense secretary and had "knowingly executed and implemented unlawful orders" by carrying out strikes against Iran. The congressman said that Hegseth "will remain a threat to the constitution if allowed to remain in office."

Hegseth was asked by a reporter Monday if he believes that he has enough Republican support in the House to defeat Massie's impeachment effort. He brushed off the question, saying "We're not worried about that."

The narrow House GOP majority can only afford a small number of defections if all Democrats support the measure. House Democratic leadership has backed the impeachment effort.

Introducing the impeachment articles Monday will force a vote by Wednesday evening unless Republicans refer the resolution to the House Judiciary Committee for investigation or vote to table it altogether. If passed, the measure heads to the Senate, which will have to hold a trial or seek to dismiss the charges, though House Speaker Mike Johnson (R-Louisiana) could seek to delay sending it to the upper chamber until the new Congress enters office in January.

The measure would face long odds in the Republican-controlled Senate. Democrats will have sizable majorities in the House and the Senate when they take power in the new year.

The Trump administration has pushed Republicans to

SEE **HEGSETH** ON **A8**

High court allows major part of border project

Section planned to cut through Texas's Big Bend has generated backlash

BY JUSTIN JOUVENAL, JAKE SPRING AND JULIAN MARK

The Supreme Court on Monday cleared the way for construction to resume on one of the longest and most controversial sections of President Donald Trump's security project along the Mexican border.

The more than 500-mile stretch of road, cameras, vehicle barriers and sensors planned to cut through Texas's iconic Big Bend National Park has generated significant backlash. It includes segments where a 30-foot border wall will be built, although the administration has backed off plans for a wall inside the park.

The justices' ruling allows work to continue while a legal challenge filed by an environmental group, preservationists, and a river guide and landowner plays out in court. Only Justice Ketanji Brown Jackson noted her dissent.

"Respondents claim that construction in the Big Bend Sector will diminish their ability to use and enjoy the area," the majority wrote. But the Illegal Immigration Reform and Immigrant Responsibility Act of 1996 "reflects a clear preference for expeditious border construction over the very harms respondents assert."

SEE **SCOTUS** ON **A9**

A bid to remake U.S.-Israel alliance

Contours of a changed relationship emerge as a new Congress takes shape

BY JOSHUA KEATING

For decades, the safest consensus position for a politician of either party looking to keep their job in Washington has been to support continued U.S. aid to Israel. After the past week, it looks increasingly clear a new political reality is emerging: that the relationship between the two countries needs to fundamentally change.

On the morning of Election Day, President Donald Trump announced that the United States would stop providing $4 billion in aid to Israel in 2027, citing a desire to take a talking point away from progressive Democratic critics of Israel such as Abdul El-Sayed, who won a Senate seat last week in Michigan. On Wednesday, after the extent of GOP losses had become clear, Vice President JD Vance went further with a post on X that suggested support for Israel was a key reason for the defeat.

Trump's announcement came as a surprise in both Washington and Jerusalem, though it remains unclear whether or when U.S. military aid to Israel will actually come to an end, given that the funds in question are allocated by Congress, not the

SEE **ISRAEL** ON **A10**

Houston, we have a wardrobe problem

NASA's spacesuit vendor is struggling to stay on track for a 2028 moon landing

BY PETER JAMISON AND ELIZABETH DWOSKIN

More than a half century after it triumphed over the Soviet Union in humanity's first space race, the United States is again vying with a communist rival to reach the moon.

But in the decades since Neil Armstrong and Buzz Aldrin left a stirring memorial plaque in the desert of another world — *We came in peace for all mankind* — much has changed. Once a symbol of superlative government competence, the nation's weakened federal space agency has largely outsourced its extraterrestrial ambitions to the private sector.

As a result of that shift, a pressing question now confronts the U.S. space program: When American astronauts return to the lunar surface, will they have anything to wear?

The answer depends on Axiom Space, a little-known vendor responsible for redesigning spacesuits that have not had a wholesale update since the 1970s. Founded in 2016 by a longtime federal contractor and a former NASA engineer, Axiom embodies the flashy ethos and uncertain prospects of what is still a largely

SEE **SPACESUITS** ON **A6**



JON SHAPLEY/AP

Spacesuit design engineer Travis Cooper, center, is helped by technicians Robert Shoemake, left, and Gregory Powasnick during a demonstration of a spacesuit prototype at Axiom Space's lab in June.

IN THE NEWS

A shift in strategy As public anger over AI grows, some tech leaders are calling for a break with the build-at-all-costs ethos that has dominated Trump's Washington. **A10**

Peace talks The U.S. has given the Kremlin an early win ahead of negotiations over the Russian war in Ukraine. **A12**

THE NATION

The Supreme Court on Monday appeared likely to curtail lawsuits filed by federal inmates who claim they have received inadequate medical care from prison officials, worrying advocates. A4

THE WORLD

The United States is unlikely to restart major military operations against Iran, Trump indicated Monday. A12

Actor Russell Brand was sentenced to more than 10 years for rape and sexual assault. A12

THE ECONOMY

Fed Chair Kevin Warsh's calendar does not show a recent meeting with the president even though Democratic senators asked him to note such events. A14

The stock market recovered most of its declines from last week as oil prices fell. A14

STYLE

The faces of women in President Donald Trump's orbit have become political Rorschach tests. B1

SPORTS

The NFL trade deadline is today. Should the Commanders be buyers or sellers? B7

THE REGION

Local Democrats' attention has shifted to a new battle: a vacant D.C. Council seat. B13

A new statue of Trump appeared Monday on the National Mall, this time mocking him for avoiding military service because of bone spurs in his feet. B13

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